Nehru, was "independence here and now". No doubt this was also the mood of the country.

The passing of the "Quit India" resolution by the Congress cleared the political atmosphere of the country vitiated by Cripps negotiations. By declaring that the Congress would launch civil disobedience movement, it forestalled all possible weakening through mutual dissension of the national will for independence, which it was the intention of the British Government to undermine by sending Sir Stafford Cripps to India.

The Congress Working Committee decided to meet early in August to discuss once again the Wardha resolution before submitting it for final ratification to the All-India Congress Committee scheduled to meet in Bombay on August 7. The political fever in the country rose as August approached. British correspondents in India complained in their despatches that Congress leaders were "*stumping the country*" *calling the people to revolt.* In any case, moderates and liberals through their frantic activities to persuade the Congress not to begin direct action before a new *modus vivendi* could be found to end the deadlock, indicated that the Congress decision effectively pointed to a revolutionary development of the political tension prevailing in the country.

The final draft resolution passed by the Congress Working Committee on August 4th, on which the All-India Congress Committee were to begin deliberations on August 7th, displayed what the correspondent of the *Manchester Guardian* called "a more constructive approach" than the Wardha resolution of mid-July. The assurance that Free India will "throw all her great resources" into the struggle on Britain's side indicated that in Congress view a free India would never contemplate a separate peace. Thus it is clear that before finally launching its decisive struggle to achieve India's freedom, the Congress went still farther in holding out the olive branch to the British Government.

On August 8th, the All-India Congress Committee adopted by overwhelming majority the Working Committee's resolution. Only a negligible minority consisting of Communists and some followers of Rajagopalachari voted against it. After the announcement of the result, Mahatma Gandhi, in a stirring ninety minute speech, gave expression to his determination to fight to the finish even if he stood alone against the whole world.

While all this was taking place, the British authorities were not